

How do birds fly?

Birds fly by flapping their wings. Their bodies are ideal for flight because they are light and shaped to cut through the air. Birds like the kingfisher can hover in midair by beating their wings very fast, while others glide on the wind by stretching their wings wide.

Birds are the only living animals with feathers.

Feathery wings

The kingfisher has large wing feathers for flying. When it flaps, the bird pushes these feathers through the air to move forward and upward.

The fastest flappers are tiny bee hummingbirds. They can beat their wings 80 times a second.

Mighty muscles

The kingfisher's large chest muscles help to power the beating of its wings when it is flying.

